

In the second pasuk of the פרשה, it says וְאֶעֱשֶׂה לְגוֹי גָדוֹל וְאֶבְרַכֶּה וְאֶגְדֹּלָה שְׁמִי וְהָיָה בְּרָכָה. In רש"י, after his first pshat, he explains that שְׁמוֹנָה עֶשְׂרֵה refers to what we say in אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹתָם: שְׁמוֹנָה עֶשְׂרֵה refers to וְאֶעֱשֶׂה לְגוֹי גָדוֹל, אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹתָם refers to וְאֶבְרַכֶּה, and שְׁמִי refers to וְאֶגְדֹּלָה. The bracha could have ended by saying וְיִצְחָק יִשְׁעָקב, מִגֵּן אֲבֹתָם יִצְחָק וְיִשְׁעָקב, "בְּךָ חֻתְמִין וְלֹא בָהֶם" - the bracha of שְׁמוֹנָה עֶשְׂרֵה ends with אֲבֹתָם.

This teaches us that the aspect of גמילות חסדים, represented by אברהם אבינו, is the foundation of all three messages.

I want to share a small מעשה that arrived today. I'm recording this during the first week of the war in ארץ ישראל. This story comes from the Boehm family: I spoke last night with a חיילת who is currently on a base in the north. She mentioned that there are many more soldiers there than usual, and they don't have enough mattresses. Someone generously donated a bunch of new mattresses for the combat soldiers, and though the soldiers are very grateful, they're not removing the plastic covering. They plan to donate these mattresses to families in the south who will need them once, בעזרת השם, the war is behind us. מי כעמך ישראל - what an incredible people.

בְּךָ חוֹתְמִין וְלֹא and the idea that וְהָיָה בְּרַכָּה, comments on מעינה של תורה quoted in ספר אהל תורה. The על שְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים הָעוֹלָם עוֹמֵד, על התורה ועל העבודה ועל גְּמִילוּת (Avos 1:2) teaches us משנה. The יצחק, גמילות חסדים אברהם: אבות represents each, since he offered himself as a קרבן; and יעקב represents תורה, as the איש תם ישב, since he represents חסדים. In the later generations, in which we are now participating, preceding the coming of משיח, the תורה tells us that תורה and עבודה will not be what they once were - and indeed, we see this. Though we may not compare to the previous generations, the גאולה will ultimately come in the merit of גמילות חסדים, as the pasuk in ישעיה (1:27) says וְשִׁבְיָהּ בְּצִדְקָהּ. That's what צִיּוֹן בְּמִשְׁפָּט תִּפְדָּהּ וְשִׁבְיָהּ בְּצִדְקָהּ, (1:27) says ישעיה. That's what רש"י means when he says בְּךָ חוֹתְמִין, he means "we will end with you" - in the גלות of חותמה, (at the end of the גלות) It will only be בְּךָ - in merit of the גמילות חסדים of אברהם אבינו, and that will make up for נבוכ, our failures in תורה and עבודה.

By the way, we still see people being **מוסר נפש** for **תורה** and **עבודה** today. Though we don't measure up to the previous generations, there are those who are doing their best. We must strive to participate in **עבודה**, **תורה**, and **גמילות חסדים**, in any way we can because these three things are the **שלושה עמודי העולם**, they keep the world in existence. Our existence in the world is tied with a **קשר** to **הקדוש ברוך הוא**.

I recently came across a dvar torah from רבי יצחק טוביה וייס, the former אב בית דין of ירושלים. It's a remarkable insight I'd like to share. If you open a פירוש קמ"ה and look at תהלה לדוד, פרק קמ"ה, you'll notice that each פסוק contains a ו, a connecting ו, that connects the first half of the פסוק to the second half, except for one פסוק: וְקָרָאֵוּ לְכָל קְרָאֵוּ לְכָל אֲשֶׁר יִקְרָאֵוּ בְּאַמֶּת: פסוק. This unique פסוק has no ו connecting the two halves. רבי וייס explains that the ו in each פסוק is a symbol of the deep bond between כלל ישראל and הקדוש ברוך הוא. The ו of וְקָרָאֵוּ represents an intrinsic חיבור that doesn't need a ו - it stands alone as a פסוק of pure connection.



Take a moment to look at תהלה לדוד and notice the ו in each פסוק. I've been saying אָשִׁירִי all these years and never saw this! It's amazing how Hashem sometimes shows you something you've been doing all your life that you've never fully appreciated.

May we recognize our profound connection to הקדוש ברוך הוא, and may our love for כלל ישראל be strong as we daven. May our enemies be defeated, may we find victory in a way that reflects the values of תורה, and may we succeed not by our own might, but by the help of Hashem's hand, with עזרת השם יתברך. May we not only survive, but be victorious.



<https://youtu.be/yLyKkRK0xJc>